THERE IS A QUIET INTENSITY IN VARUN NAGARAJ'S VOICE as he speaks about the way forward for S.P. Jain Institute of Management & Research (SPJIMR). As the dean of this 44-year-old Mumbai-based institute, he exudes both urgency and assurance when discussing how prepared the school is to meet the technological demands reshaping management education.

"There are two kinds of initiatives that we undertake, and both are aligned to SPJIMR's vision, which is to create next-generation managers," he explains. The first reflects the institute's enduring ethos over the past four decades: ensuring that students leave with not just knowledge, but the tools and mindset to innovate responsibly.

"Systems thinking becomes a big element of a manager's toolkit," Nagaraj elaborates. Introduced as a mandatory first-year course, it is paired with design thinking to help students comprehend the full picture and make judicious decisions. Students are also encouraged to interview innovators and study what the institute calls 'wise innovations'. Under this ethos, the WISE Tech India Pitchathon 2025 reached nearly 700 start-ups across 12 cities. Thirty-five 'wise innovations' were selected to present in Mumbai, with five emerging as winners.

TOP 10 PRIVATE B-SCHOOLS

RANK 2025	NAME OF THE INSTITUTE	CITY
1	S. P. JAIN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT & RESEARCH	*Mumbai*
2	XLRI — XAVIER SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT	*Jamshedpur*
3	MANAGEMENT DEVELOPMENT INSTITUTE (MDI) GURGAON	*Gurugram*
4	SVKM'S NMIMS, SCHOOL OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT	*Mumbai*
5	SYMBIOSIS INSTITUTE OF BUSINESS MANAGEMENT	*Pune*
6	SYMBIOSIS CENTRE FOR MANAGEMENT & HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT	*Pune*
7	INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT TECHNOLOGY	*Ghaziabad*
8	INTERNATIONAL MANAGEMENT INSTITUTE	*New Delhi*
9	GREAT LAKES INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT	*Chennai*
9	XAVIER INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT	*Bhubaneswar*
10	T. A. PAI MANAGEMENT INSTITUTE	*Manipal*

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